

Blue Yonder VMware Environment Summary

Extracted from Intro Call with Red Hat — April 14, 2026

Scale & Geography

- Roughly 10,000 on-prem VMs today (number is shrinking as workloads migrate to Azure)
- Long-term projection: ~2,500 VMs across 25–30 hosts after Azure migrations
- 4 data centers globally: 2 US-based (Kansas City and Dallas) and 2 EMEA-based
- 99.999% virtualized — exclusively ESXi

Operating System Mix

- 60–65% Windows, remainder Linux
- Windows: mostly Server 2012, 2016, 2019; some legacy 2008 and possibly 2003 still in environment
- Linux: RHEL 6 through 8, plus some Oracle Enterprise Linux 6 and 7

Hardware

- Dell pizza-box servers, primarily 2-socket
- A few blade servers remaining (being phased out)
- Multiple processor generations across hosts (4–5 generations spanning some clusters), which is why EVC mode is enabled

Storage

- Pure Storage flash arrays as primary backend
- Fiber channel connectivity
- Some NFS shares used for non-production purposes (templates, DR copies)
- A handful of RDMS (fewer than 6) for dedicated cluster servers

Networking

- Standard VLANs on Cisco and Arista
- NSX was implemented at one point but scrapped — not currently in use

VMware Features in Use

- ESXi (no Tanzu — firmly not interested)
- DRS with standard workload-based migration (nothing aggressive)
- DRS anti-affinity rules (e.g., separating active/passive Palo Alto firewall pairs)
- EVC mode enabled across clusters (necessary due to mixed CPU generations)

- vSphere SRM and Zerto for DR between sites
- No Aria; limited automation mostly via PowerShell scripting and some Control-M

Cluster Strategy

- Cluster breakdown driven primarily by licensing (separate Linux, Windows, Oracle clusters)
- Some additional Windows cluster splits due to incompatible processor generations
- VM provisioning via templates, clones, and PowerShell — no Aria

Multi-tenancy & Customer Model

- Blue Yonder runs a SaaS-style cloud business — customers access the application, not the VMs
- No customer-level multi-tenancy at the infrastructure layer; Blue Yonder fully manages the back end
- Major customers include Starbucks, Albertsons, and Advance Auto

Strategic Context

- VMware licensing agreement expires April 2028 — mandate to be off VMware before then
- Long-term direction is to exit private data centers entirely for Azure, but a forklift migration isn't feasible
- Looking for an interim hypervisor; some workloads may stay on-prem long-term due to performance
- Want flexibility to pivot to containers/Kubernetes in the future
- Already evaluated 8–9 alternatives, including Spectro Cloud
- Currently doing a Portworx POC with another vendor